

Website Design & Build Working Document honestcarsltd.com

Functional & design specification for the official Honest Cars LTD digital platform — car storefront, full services suite, dealer portal & operations back-office

This document tells the web development team exactly what to design and build, why, and in what order. It covers the minimalist design system, the listings-first storefront, every service and product page, customer accounts, the dealer partner portal, the admin back-office that runs day-to-day business operations, integrations, performance & SEO requirements, phased delivery and acceptance criteria.

CLIENT / PRODUCT OWNER	Honest Cars LTD, Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Nigeria
PRODUCT	Public website + dealer portal + admin console for honestcarsltd.com
AUDIENCE OF THIS DOCUMENT	Project manager, UI/UX designer, front-end & back-end developers, QA, content writer, digital marketer
COMPANION DOCUMENT	Honest Cars LTD — Business Operating Document v1.0 (defines the services & pricing this website must sell and support)
VERSION	1.0 • Prepared: September 2026 • Review: at each build-phase gate

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1 Purpose, Scope & How to Use This Document

What this document is, who it is for, and how decisions get made

1.1 Purpose

This working document is the single source of truth for designing and building **honestcarsltd.com**, the official digital platform of Honest Cars LTD. It translates the company's Business Operating Document (v1.0) into a concrete website: a **minimalist, listings-first storefront** fed by dealer-partner inventory, wrapped by the complete suite of HonestCars services and products, and backed by portals/tools that allow the team to **run the day-to-day business through the website**.

1.2 The One-Sentence Brief

BRIEF IN ONE LINE

Build a fast, mobile-first, minimalist website where **the cars are the hero** and every visitor is never more than two clicks from any HonestCars service — while the back-office quietly powers listings, leads, bookings, payments, dispatches and reporting for the operations team.

1.3 In Scope vs. Out of Scope (v1)

In Scope — build now	Out of Scope — later / never via this project
- Public marketing site + car marketplace fed by dealer partners - All consumer services: concierge search, inspections, customs & documents, swap/sell, research reports, consultations, tracking, car hire, parts sourcing - Products shop (trackers, OBD2 scanners, care kits) - Blog & content engine (the Honest Buyer's Guide) with live car-listing embeds, CMS publishing workflow and RSS - Customer accounts, dealer partner portal, admin back-office - Payments, WhatsApp integration, notifications, analytics, SEO foundations	- Native iOS/Android apps (mobile web / PWA-first strategy) - Financing/loan origination engine (sectioned as "future") - Vehicle auction bidding engine - HonestCars becoming a telematics platform (we integrate partners, not rebuild them) - Multi-country versions (single-country, multi-city structure only)

1.4 How the Team Should Use It

Role	Sections to Own
Project Manager	Everything; especially §18 phasing, §19 open questions, §9 requirements register
UI/UX Designer	§3 design system, §5 IA, §6 page specs, Appendix A wireframes, §13 mobile strategy
Front-end Developer	§6, §12 NFRs, §13, §14 SEO, Appendix A
Back-end Developer	§7 portals/admin, §9 requirements, §10 data model, §11 integrations, §12 security
QA	§9 requirement IDs, §18.3 acceptance checklist, §12 NFRs, §8 journeys as test scripts
Content / Marketing	§16 content requirements, §14 SEO, Appendix D microcopy

1.5 Decision & Change Control

- Anything marked **MUST** is contractual for launch; **SHOULD** is in launch unless timeline forces deferral to Phase 2; **COULD** is backlog.
- Changes require a written change request to the Product Owner (HonestCars MD) with impact on cost/timeline noted.
- Unspecified visual decisions default to the design principles in §3 — when in doubt, choose the simpler option.

2 Product Vision, Objectives & Success Metrics

What winning looks like for honestcarsltd.com

2.1 Vision Statement

VISION

honestcarsltd.com is the most trusted place in the South-South to find a verified car and get anything automobile-related done — the digital front door and operating backbone of the HonestCars ecosystem.

2.2 Business Objectives (in priority order)

#	Objective	What the Website Must Do to Achieve It
1	Sell partner inventory	Listings front-and-centre; high-quality vehicle pages; frictionless enquiry → viewing → concierge close; every lead captured, routed and tracked
2	Convert visitors into service customers	Clear services suite (inspections, concierge, documents, tracking, hire, research, consultations) with online booking & payment
3	Run daily operations on the platform	Admin console for listing moderation, booking dispatch, order & payment management, lead routing, subscriptions and reporting — reducing WhatsApp chaos, not adding to it
4	Grow the dealer network	Dealer portal for self-serve listings, lead inbox and performance stats; a public “Partner With Us” funnel
5	Build the brand & organic pipeline	SEO-strong architecture + the blog (home of the Honest Buyer’s Guide) + shareable WhatsApp-friendly pages
6	Establish recurring digital revenue	Tracking subscription activation/renewals, dealer retainers visible & payable online

2.3 Measurable Success Criteria (launch + 90 days)

Metric	Target
Page speed — LCP on mid-range Android over “Fast 3G”	< 2.5s on listings & vehicle pages
Live listings on launch day / +90 days	150+ / 400+
Listing → enquiry conversion	≥ 4% of vehicle page views generate a lead
Concierge requests via site	≥ 20/month by day 90
Online bookings (inspections/consultations)	≥ 40% of total bookings processed via site by day 90
Dealer portal adoption	≥ 60% of partner listings dealer-submitted (not admin-typed) by day 90
Admin time saved	Listing publish < 10 min; lead routing automatic; daily report auto-generated

2.4 Guiding Product Principles

1. Cars front and centre

The store is the beachhead. Search, inventory and car cards dominate the homepage; services orbit them visibly.

2. Two clicks to anything

Every service and product is reachable in ≤ 2 clicks from anywhere (persistent nav + smart cross-links).

3. Mobile is the product

Most visitors arrive on phones over mobile data. Design mobile first; treat PC as an enhancement, not the baseline.

4. Speed is a feature

Every image, script and font is justified against a performance budget (§12, §13). Slow = broken.

5. Trust is visual, not claimed

Verification badges, inspection grades, price-position indicators and real photos do the persuading — not adjectives.

6. Protect the middleman position

Dealer contact details are never exposed; all buyer contact flows through HonestCars channels (enquiry forms, masked WhatsApp).

7. WhatsApp is a native citizen

Deep links, share previews and chat CTAs everywhere — that is how this market transacts.

8. Minimalism with warmth

Whitespace, restraint, one accent action colour — paired with plain-language, human copy (§3, §16).

3 Brand & Design Direction — The Minimalist System

Look, feel, voice and the rules that keep it honest

3.1 Design Personality

“A quiet showroom run by a straight-talker.” Minimalist and functional like a premium showroom — nothing decorative without a job — with the frankness of a trusted mechanic. Reference feel: clean automotive marketplaces (white space, strong photography, disciplined grids) crossed with a modern fintech’s clarity.

3.2 Colour System

Token	Hex	Usage
--honest-navy	#0E2A47	Primary brand — headers, footer, headings, key text
--honest-green	#12A150	The one action colour — primary CTAs, verified badges, success states
--honest-amber	#E8A13D	Sparing accents — “Field-Checked” badge, warnings, highlights (never for primary CTAs)
--ink / --muted	#1D2733 / #5B6B7C	Body text / secondary text
--surface / --line	#F7FAFC / #D8E0E8	Card backgrounds / dividers & borders
--white	#FFFFFF	Dominant canvas — the site should feel mostly white

3.3 Typography & Iconography

- **Primary typeface:** Inter (self-hosted; system stack `-apple-system`, Segoe UI, Roboto as instant fallback). One family only, weights 400/500/600/700.
- **Scale (mobile base):** 12 / 14 / 16 (body) / 20 / 24 / 32 — headings clamp up on desktop; never below 14px for readable content.
- **Prices** always in **£** with figure-friendly tabular styling; mileage in km.
- **Icons:** single-line icon set (e.g., Lucide/Feather style), 1.5px stroke, no mixing of icon families.

3.4 Layout & Component Rules

- **8px spacing grid;** max content width 1200px; generous whitespace; no carousels that hide content (static grids with “View all”).
- **Cards:** white, 1px #D8E0E8 border, 12px radius, subtle shadow on hover (desktop only).
- **Buttons:** 3 kinds only — primary (solid green), secondary (navy outline), ghost (text). One primary action visible per screen area.
- **Photography direction:** real lot photos, daylight, consistent framing guide issued to dealers (front $\frac{3}{4}$, side, rear $\frac{3}{4}$, interior, dashboard, engine bay, odometer close-up). No stock-photo handshakes.
- **Motion:** ≤ 200 ms ease transitions; no parallax, no autoplay sliders, respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.

- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.1 AA contrast (test green on white), focus states visible, all forms labelled, tap targets $\geq 44\text{px}$.

3.5 The Trust Component System (signature UI)

Component	Meaning & Visual
Verification badge	Three grades shown on every car card & VDP: ● Network-Listed (grey — dealer data, unverified) · ● Field-Checked (amber — physically seen) · ● HonestCars-Certified (green — full inspection passed). Tooltip explains each grade in one line.
Price-Position indicator	Subtle label on VDP: “Within market band / Below market / Premium” — driven by the pricing database (\$10). Where price history exists, show “price unchanged 21 days”.
Documents strip	Icon row: Customs verified ✓ · Registration ✓ · Duty papers sighted ✓ — green when verified, grey when pending.
Timeline chip	“Listed 3 days ago · Updated today” — freshness is trust.
Honest note	A short, plainly-written condition truth on certified cars, e.g. “AC blows cold; two panels resprayed; tyres at ~60%.” Framed box, amber border.

3.6 Tone of Voice

Plain English, short sentences, zero jargon without explanation, numbers over adjectives. Say “We checked this car ourselves on 14 Sept” not “quality assured”. Humour allowed in content hub, never in checkout flows. Write like the honest friend who knows cars — never like a marketer.

4 Audiences & User Personas

Design and build for these five people

Persona	Profile & Device Reality	Primary Goals on the Site	Design Implications
“The Careful Buyer” — Chidi, 34, oil-servicing engineer	iPhone/Android on MTN data; browses evenings; shares everything to WhatsApp groups for opinions	Browse verified cars, compare prices honestly, book inspection, use concierge, pay securely	Fast listing grids, prominent filter by budget, share buttons with rich OG previews, verification badges, saved-cars list, clear ₦ totals
“The Upgrader” — Mrs. Amadi, 47, business owner	Low patience for forms; prefers talking to a human on WhatsApp	Sell/swap current car, valuation, get documents sorted	Short forms with WhatsApp fallback at every step; human-callout CTAs; progress saved automatically
“The Dealer” — Emeka, lot owner, Aba Road	Android phone, moderate digital skill, busy	Upload cars fast, see leads, know what he owes/earns, order media shoots	Dealer portal mobile-first, photo-first upload (camera → fields pre-filled later), WhatsApp notifications, one-screen dashboard
“The Fleet Admin” — HR/Facilities officer, oil & gas firm	Desktop at office, needs documentation	Book hire vehicles, request fleet quotes, tracking proposals, download invoices	Clean B2B pages, RFQ forms, downloadable PDF quotes/invoices, account-style billing
“The Operator” — HonestCars staff	Laptops + phones; lives in the admin console	Moderate listings, dispatch inspectors, route leads, track payments, publish content	Admin optimized for speed: bulk actions, keyboard-friendly, WhatsApp templates, daily KPI home

5 Information Architecture & Navigation

Sitemap, menus and the 2-click rule

5.1 Top-Level Sitemap

Public — Storefront

/ Home
 /cars All listings · /cars/{slug} VDP
 /cars/compare Compare tool
 /find-my-car Concierge request
 /sell-swap Sell or swap flow
 /hire Car hire
 /services Services hub + 8 service pages
 /shop Products + categories + checkout
 /blog Blog — posts, categories, tags, search ·
 /blog/{slug} article
 /guide Curated “Honest Buyer’s Guide”
 evergreen shelf (start-here reads from the blog)
 /how-it-works · /about · /verification (trust
 page) · /faq · /contact
 /partner Dealer recruitment page
 Legal: /terms /privacy /refunds /
 disclaimer

Authenticated

/account Customer dashboard (overview,
 requests, bookings, orders, saved cars,
 documents, tracked vehicles, referrals)

 /dealer Dealer portal (dashboard, my listings,
 add listing, leads, performance, orders &
 commissions, profile)

 /admin Ops console (KPI home, listings
 moderation, verification queue, bookings &
 dispatch, orders & payments, concierge pipeline,
 hire calendar, CRM/leads, dealers, subscriptions,
 CMS, price-intel, reports, settings)

5.2 Navigation Model

- **Desktop header** (sticky, white, slim): Logo · **Buy Cars** · **Services ▼** (mega-menu with 8 services, icon + one-liner each) · **Sell/Swap** · **Hire** · **Blog** · Search icon · Account icon · **[Find My Car]** primary green button.
- **Mobile**: hamburger opens full-height drawer (same items, accordion Services). **Persistent bottom bar** (after first scroll): Home · Cars · Find My Car · Chat (WhatsApp) · Account.
- **Persistent floating WhatsApp button** bottom-right on all public pages (respects bottom nav — sits above it, collapsible).
- **Footer**: 4 columns — Shop (All cars, Compare, Find My Car, Sell/Swap, Hire) / Services (all 8 + shop links) / Company (About, Verification, Partner, Blog, Contact, Careers-later) / Legal; plus contact block, CAC/registration line, payment-partner marks, and “Port Harcourt, Nigeria” local note.
- **Cross-links**: every service page ends with related listings or related service cards; every VDP surfaces inspection, concierge, tracking and hire cross-sells (§6.3). This is how the “plethora of services” stays discoverable without cluttering the store.

THE 2-CLICK ACCEPTANCE TEST

From the homepage, a first-time mobile user must reach any of: (a) a car listing, (b) the concierge form, (c) an inspection booking, (d) the shop, (e) WhatsApp chat — in **no more than 2 taps**. QA verifies this in §18.3.

6 Public-Facing Pages — Detailed Specifications

Every page: purpose, modules, CTAs, priority. Wireframes in Appendix A.

6.1 Homepage **MUST**

Purpose: Put live cars in front of the visitor within one viewport, prove trust in 5 seconds, and route every other intent (services, sell/swap, hire, B2B) with zero hunting.

Section-by-section (top → bottom)

Module	Specification
1. Sticky header	As §5.2. Slim (≤64px), white, soft shadow after scroll.
2. Hero + instant search	H1: “Every vehicle verified. Every price compared. Every deal honest.” Sub: one line on what HonestCars is. Search bar (Make · Model · Max budget ₦ · [Search]) → results at /cars with filters applied. Beneath: 3 trust chips — {n} cars live now · {n} partner dealers in PH · Verified listings only badge system.
3. Live inventory grid	“Fresh on the market” — 8 car cards (randomised mix of certified first), “View all {n} cars →”. Tabs: All / Certified ✓ / Under ₦10m / SUVs (tab values configurable in admin).
4. How it works	3 steps with icons: ① Pick a car or tell us what you want → ② We verify & compare prices for you → ③ Buy with protection, documents sorted.
5. Verification grades strip	The 3-badge explainer (§3.5) — one horizontal strip, links to /verification .
6. Services suite grid	“More than a car store” — 8 icon cards (Inspection, Concierge Search, Customs & Documents, Sell/Swap, Tracking, Car Hire, Research & Reports, Spare Parts) each with one-line promise + arrow. This is the primary discovery surface for the service suite.
7. Social proof	3–4 testimonials with real names/areas + counters (cars verified, deals closed, ₦ saved for buyers — admin-editable).
8. From the Blog	3 latest posts/videos — led by the Honest Buyer’s Guide series.
9. Dealer CTA band	Navy band: “Own a car lot in PH? We bring you buyers.” → /partner .
10. Deal-alert opt-in	“Get hot verified deals on WhatsApp first” — phone input + consent checkbox (NDPA-compliant).
11. Footer	As §5.2.

6.2 Car Listings — </cars> **MUST**

Purpose: The store. Fast, filterable, honest browsing of partner inventory.

Layout

- **Desktop:** left filter rail (sticky 260px) + results grid (3-col). **Mobile:** full-width 1–2 col cards; “Filter” button opens a bottom-sheet with Apply/Clear and live result count.
- **Result header:** “128 cars in Port Harcourt” + sort (Recommended / Price ↑ ↓ / Newest / Lowest mileage) + saved-search button.

Filters (left rail / sheet)

Budget range (₦ slider + inputs) · Make & model (dependent selects, counts shown) · Year range · Condition (Tokunbo / Nigerian-used / New) · Body type · Transmission · Fuel type · Mileage max · **Verification grade** (Certified only toggle — defaults off, visually promoted) · Location (PH areas; future cities) · Documents (customs-verified only) · Colour.

Car card anatomy

- Photo (4:3, WebP, lazy-loaded), verification badge top-left, “Certified report” ribbon if inspection exists.
- Year Make Model Trim · price (₦, bold navy) · price-position dot (if data) · spec line: mileage · transmission · fuel · location area.
- Actions row: **[View]**, “+ Compare” checkbox, WhatsApp icon (prefilled message with car ref).
- **Sold/Reserved states:** badge overlay; sold cars remain visible 7 days (“Sold in 6 days” is social proof) then archive to SEO-friendly “sold archive” with similar-cars links.

Behaviour rules

- URL reflects filters (shareable links); no full-page reloads (AJAX or static-filter approach); “Load more” pagination (24/page) — no infinite scroll traps before footer cross-links.
- Empty state: “No exact matches — {n} near matches” + concierge CTA (“We’ll find it for you in 48–72 hours →”). **Every empty state routes to the concierge.**

6.3 Vehicle Detail Page (VDP) — /cars/{slug} **MUST**

Purpose: The closing page. Everything needed to trust and act, nothing else.

Desktop layout

- **Left (60%):** gallery (main image + thumbs, pinch-zoom on mobile, video tab if present, 360° embed if media package exists) → below: full spec grid (12–16 fields), features list, description, “Honest note” condition box (certified cars), documents strip.
- **Right rail (40%, sticky):** price + price-position · verification badge · key facts (year/mileage/transmission/location) · CTA stack: **[Request Viewing]** (primary) · **[Buy via HonestCars Concierge]** (secondary, explains protected purchase) · [Chat on WhatsApp] (ghost) · share icons (WhatsApp, copy link) · “+ Compare” · safety note (“All payments go through HonestCars-protected channels. Never pay a seller directly.”) · dealer shown only as “Partner dealer · PH — verified by HonestCars” (no contact info — lead protection, §2.4-6).
- **Below fold:** inspection section (if certified: grade summary, OBD2 code count, 6-photo strip, “download full report PDF” gated by enquiry or ₦ micro-fee config) → service cross-sell strip (tracker install · insurance/docs · hire-a-driver note) → similar cars (same make or budget band) → recently viewed.

VDP rules

- Every VDP carries: freshness chip, stock #, canonical URL, Vehicle schema markup (§14), and OG tags tuned for WhatsApp sharing (image + “2015 Toyota Camry · ₦8.5m · HonestCars-Verified” title).
- “Request Viewing” opens a 3-field modal (name, phone, preferred day) → creates lead in admin + auto-WhatsApp to ops queue. No account required to enquire (guest-first; account offered post-action).

6.4 Compare Cars — </cars/compare> **SHOULD**

- Up to 3 selected cars side-by-side (sticky header row of photos/prices) across: price, price-position, year, mileage, transmission, fuel, condition grade, documents status, known faults (certified), running-cost estimate.
- Highlight best value per row (green tick); “Ask HonestCars to choose for me” button → concierge lead with compare context attached.

6.5 “Find My Car” Concierge — </find-my-car> **MUST**

Purpose: Flagship service. A guided multi-step form replaces the intimidating search — SLA: 3 verified options in 48-72 hours.

Flow (4 steps, progress bar, auto-saved)

1. **The car you want:** budget slider (min-max), make/model multi-select or “not sure”, body type, transmission, fuel, must-haves (chips: “AC must chill”, “low mileage”, “first-car friendly”, “fuel economy”, “family size”...), intended use (commute/family/business/ride-hailing).
2. **Protection options:** pre-checked “physical inspection of every option ✓” (included), optional add-ons: document deep-verification, tracker install on delivery, post-purchase service intro.
3. **About you:** name, WhatsApp number (OTP-lite later), timeline (ASAP/2 weeks/month/researching), financing needed? Y/N (routes to partner note).
4. **Retainer & confirmed SLA:** price card (retainer ₦X — credited against success fee; “refunded if we find nothing that meets your brief”), Paystack/Flutterwave inline pay → success screen with **tracking ID + status page link** (</concierge/{id}>): Searching → Options ready → Viewings → Closed stages; pushes WhatsApp updates at each stage).

Admin side drives this pipeline (\$7.3). Abandoned step-3 forms trigger one polite WhatsApp follow-up template.

6.6 Sell / Swap — </sell-swap> **MUST**

- **Tab 1 — Sell my car:** 3-step intake (car basics + photos upload guide → condition & documents → contact). Output promise: “Free valuation within 24h from live network data.” Books optional paid inspection for certified listing (higher price positioning).
- **Tab 2 — Swap/upgrade:** combines sell intake + “what you want instead” (reuses concierge step-1 component) → creates swap engagement in admin.
- Instant estimate widget **COULD**: rough band from pricing DB with “confirm with free human valuation” CTA.

6.7 Services Hub & Service Pages — </services> **MUST**

Hub: grid of all services (same 8 as homepage + any future), each card → dedicated page. Consistent service-page template (so all “plethora of services” feel like one coherent suite):

Template block	Content
Hero	Service name, one-line promise, “from ₦X” price anchor, primary CTA (Book/Request), WhatsApp ghost CTA, small trust line (jobs done count)
What you get	4-6 bullet deliverables with icons; what’s included / not included mini-table
How it works	3-5 numbered steps with realistic timelines
Pricing table	Tiers as per Business Operating Document §12 (admin-editable price cards)

Proof	1-2 mini case notes / testimonials for that service
FAQ accordion	5-8 service-specific FAQs
Conversion block	Inline booking/request form + related services + related listings (where sensible)

The service pages (slugs & booking mechanism)

Page	Slug	Inline Action (all create admin records; payment where priced)
Pre-Purchase Inspection	/services/inspection	Book: car details + location + time-slot picker + pay → calendar booking + inspector dispatch queue
Customs & Document Services	/services/documents	Request wizard (verification / licence renewal / registration / tinted permit / insurance) + upload papers photos + pay
Find-My-Car Concierge	/services/concierge	Rich service page wrapping \$6.5 flow
Car Tracking & Security	/services/tracking	Bundle picker (Standard / Premium / Fleet) → install booking + subscription checkout (recurring via PSP)
Car Hire	/hire	Request form (dates, vehicle class, with-driver?, airport pickup toggle for Omagwa) → quote workflow; corporate RFQ variant
Research & Reports	/services/research	Product cards: TCO report · Auction sourcing analysis · Market price check → brief form + pay (48-72h delivery to account)
Paid Consultation	/services/consultation	30-min slot picker (calendar of rep availability) + pay → video-call link auto-issued
Spare-Parts Sourcing (Escrow)	/services/parts	Part request form (VIN-compatible fields) → quote → milestone payment flow
B2B: Dealer Services	/partner	Recruitment + media/lead-gen/intelligence packages enquiry → B2B lead pipeline; links to dealer portal login

6.8 Products Shop — /shop **MUST**

- **Categories:** Trackers & Security · OBD2 & Diagnostics · Care Kits · (Parts are service-led → route to §6.7 parts page, not self-checkout).
- **Product card/page:** photo(s), price, stock status, key specs, “installation included?” toggle where relevant (tracker install = booking at checkout), warranty line, delivery options (pickup meet-point / PH delivery).
- **Cart + checkout:** guest checkout allowed; Paystack/Flutterwave inline; delivery-fee rules by area (admin table); order confirmation + WhatsApp notification; orders visible in account + admin order manager.
- Tracker SKUs auto-create a subscription record (activation checklist in admin: device installed → platform activated → renewal date set).

6.9 Blog — Home of the Honest Buyer’s Guide — /blog **MUST**

Purpose: The organic-growth and trust engine. Every post is a silent salesperson: it answers a real Nigerian car question, proves expertise, and routes the reader to live listings and paid services. The

flagship editorial strand is the **“Honest Buyer’s Guide”** series (brutally honest vehicle reality content), supported by market intel and company news.

Blog home — `/blog`

- **Featured post** hero card (admin-pinned) + category chip bar: All · Honest Buyer’s Guide · Ownership & Maintenance · Market Intel & Prices · Company News · Video.
- Latest-posts grid (9 per “load more”), search box, tag links, “Get hot verified deals on WhatsApp” opt-in band, RSS link.

Post page — `/blog/{slug}`

- 16:9 hero image, H1, meta row (author, date, read time); long posts get an auto table-of-contents with anchor links.
- Body components: callout boxes, checklists, comparison tables, quote blocks, embedded YouTube (facade lazy-embed for speed).
- **“Cars mentioned in this article”** module — auto-pulls live listings matching the post’s make/model tags (content sells inventory).
- Author card (name, role, short bio — E-E-A-T), share row (WhatsApp · X · Facebook · copy link — OG cards tuned for chat previews), related posts (3), prev/next navigation.
- Contextual service CTA footer (inspection / concierge / consultation, chosen by category); optional FAQ block (FAQPage schema).
- “Was this helpful?” feedback widget; **no public comments at launch** (moderation cost — **COULD** later).

Publishing & governance (CMS)

- Workflow states: draft → in review → scheduled → published; Content/Marketing role publishes (\$7.4); revision history; slug/meta editor; auto Article schema, branded OG card template and sitemap inclusion.
- `/guide` serves as the curated evergreen shelf — a “start-here” reading path drawn from the Honest Buyer’s Guide category.
- Cadence 2–3 posts/week (owner assigned per \$19); house rules: every post links ≥ 3 listing/service pages; categories fixed, tags governed; video scripts repurposed into posts and vice versa.

6.10 Trust, Company & Legal Pages **MUST**

- `/verification` — the trust page: explains the three grades, the HonestCars Checklist, photo examples of catches (flood, odometer), integrity rules (“inspectors never take seller money”).
Most underrated page on the site — give it design love.
- `/how-it-works`, `/about` (story, mission, team, CAC details), `/faq` (searchable, grouped), `/contact` (form + WhatsApp + address-note “We operate virtually in PH — inspections come to you”).
- Legal: `/terms` `/privacy` (NDPA-aligned) `/refunds` `/disclaimer` (inspection-report liability wording, price-band disclaimer) — copy supplied by HonestCars legal retainer; dev builds CMS-editable pages.

7 Accounts, Dealer Portal & Admin Back-Office

The machinery that lets HonestCars run its daily business on the website

7.1 Customer Account — /account **MUST**

Phone-number-first auth (OTP via WhatsApp/SMS), email optional. Dashboard cards: **Requests** (concierge/sell/swap/parts statuses with timeline) · **Bookings** (inspections, consultations, installs) · **Orders** (shop + receipts/invoice PDFs) · **Saved cars & searches** (with price-drop / new-match toggles) · **Hire bookings** · **My tracked vehicles** (link-out to telematics partner app + subscription status/renewal) · **Documents** (reports, memos, receipts in one place) · **Referrals** (personal link + reward status).

7.2 Dealer Partner Portal — /dealer **SHOULD (PHASE 2 HARD REQUIREMENT)**

Module	Specification
Dashboard	One screen: live listings count, leads this week, views per listing, pending actions (expiring listings, unconfirmed stock), commission summary
My Listings	Table + card views; states: Draft / In review / Live / Reserved / Sold / Expired; quick actions (mark sold, edit price, add photos); bulk CSV upload COULD
Add Listing wizard	Mobile-first: photograph first (guided shot list: front ¾, rear, interior, dash, odometer, engine) → spec form (per schema §10) → documents status checklist → submit for review. Draft autosaves; admin approval required before Live (moderation queue)
Leads inbox	Buyer enquiries attributed to his listings (name, phone masked or full per policy, car ref, message, status); must update lead status (contacted/viewing/sold/lost) — feeds admin pipeline
Performance	Listing views, enquiries, response time scorecard; freshness score (+ nudge when listings go stale >14 days)
Orders & Billing	Commission statements per closed deal; pay for add-on services (media shoot, featured placement, intelligence subscription) via PSP
Profile & Agreement	Business details, lot location, digital copy of signed partnership agreement, tier badge

7.3 Admin Console — /admin **MUST**

Module	Key Functions (what “runs the business” means concretely)
KPI Home	Today: new leads, bookings, payments ₦, pending verifications, listings expiring. Charts: listings trend, lead funnel, revenue by service line. One-click daily summary to WhatsApp/email
Listings Moderation	Approval queue (dealer submissions), edit/override, verification-grade setter (Network-Listed → Field-Checked → Certified with checklist attachment), expiry automation (14-day stale → request refresh → auto-unlist), sold archive
Leads / CRM-lite	Unified inbox: listing enquiries, concierge, service requests, hire, B2B. Auto-assign rules (round-robin/owner), status pipeline, WhatsApp reply templates, follow-up reminders, lost-reason capture

Concierge Pipeline	Board view by stage (New → Searching → Options ready → Viewings → Closed); attach candidate cars to a request (generates the buyer's comparison PDF semi-auto from listing data + inspector notes); SLA timer per request (48-72h)
Bookings & Dispatch	Calendar of inspections/consultations/installs; assign inspector; inspector mobile view (today's jobs, checklist form: OBD2 codes, photo capture per section, verdict grades → auto-generates the client report PDF); slot capacity settings
Orders & Payments	All PSP transactions; statuses (paid/pending/refunded); receipts; payout/commission ledger per dealer; milestone tracker for protected purchases & parts escrow (stage: funds received → inspection pass → documents verified → released — manual approvals with audit log)
Hire Management	Vehicle pool registry (partner-owned units, docs, tracker status), availability calendar, booking records, incident log
Subscriptions	Tracking subscriptions (unit, client, plan, renewal date, status); renewal queue + auto reminders (30/7/1 day); dealer retainer/subs management
Inventory Pricing Intel	Market price-band table per make/model/year (drives price-position indicator + valuation tool); weekly update form + audit history
CMS	Blog posts & media, pages, FAQs, testimonials, homepage modules (featured cars, trust counters, banners), service price cards
Users & Roles	Staff accounts with role matrix (\$7.4); dealer approvals; watchlist flag; audit log of sensitive actions (price overrides, payment releases, grade changes)
Reports	Date-ranged exports: sales/leads/revenue by pillar, inspector productivity, dealer performance, marketing UTMs (CSV/PDF)

7.4 Roles & Permission Matrix

Capability	Super Admin	Ops Manager	Inspector	Content/Marketing	Finance	Dealer
Moderate & publish listings	✓	✓	—	—	—	Submit only
Set verification grade	✓	✓ (with audit)	Recommend	—	—	—
Manage leads & concierge	✓	✓	View assigned	—	—	Own leads only
Bookings & dispatch	✓	✓	Own jobs + checklist	—	—	—
Payments, refunds, milestones, payouts	✓	View	—	—	✓ (approvals)	Own statements
CMS & marketing modules	✓	✓	—	✓	—	—
Price-intel table	✓	✓	—	—	View	—
Users, roles, audit log	✓	—	—	—	—	—

7.5 Day-to-Day Workflow → Module Mapping (acceptance scenarios)

Daily business moment (from Operations Plan)	How the website handles it
9:00 — Dealer posts 6 new cars	Dealer portal upload → moderation queue badge → ops approves → live + auto “fresh on the market” eligibility
10:15 — Buyer enquiry on a Camry	VDP form/WhatsApp → CRM inbox → auto-assign → template reply → lead status tracked to outcome
11:30 — Inspection booked	Payment confirmed → calendar slot → inspector gets job on phone → checklist → client report PDF auto-emailed & filed to VIN record
14:00 — Concierge options ready	Ops attaches 3 cars + notes → system renders comparison page/PDF → buyer gets WhatsApp link, status auto-moves
16:45 — Tracker installed	Install checklist → subscription record activated → renewal reminders scheduled → MRR dashboard updates
Friday — Pricing refresh	Ops updates price-intel table → price-position indicators recalc site-wide
Month-end — Dealer commissions	Ledger → statement → dealer sees in portal → payout via PSP; results feed monthly report export

8 Key User Journeys (acceptance test scripts)

Each must run end-to-end without staff leaving the admin console

Journey	Steps (happy path)	Done when...
J1 — Buyer finds & acts on a car	Home search → filters → VDP → compare 2 cars → Request Viewing → WhatsApp confirmation → viewing scheduled → buyer opts “Buy via Concierge” → milestone payments → handover → review prompt	Lead, viewing, payment milestones, review all recorded against the listing & user; dealer notified at each stage
J2 — “Find it for me”	Concierge form → retainer paid → tracking ID issued → admin search → options page → viewing → close → cross-sell tracker/docs	SLA timer visible; buyer never had to call; all artefacts stored in account
J3 — Inspection booking	Service page → slot → pay → inspector executes checklist on mobile → report delivered ≤4h → upsell prompt	Report auto-generated from checklist (no re-typing); dispute flags exist
J4 — Dealer submits stock	Portal login → photo-first wizard → review queue → live → receives lead → marks sale → statement updates	Dealer needs zero admin chat for the whole loop; stale-listing nudge fires at day 14
J5 — Tracker purchase → subscription	Shop bundle → checkout with install slot → install checklist → subscription active → renewal reminder → renewal pays online	Subscription lifecycle fully visible in admin; no spreadsheet needed
J6 — Corporate hire request	/hire RFQ → ops quote (template) → client accepts & pays → booking calendar → completion + invoice PDF	Quote/accept/pay trail digital end-to-end
J7 — Research report purchase	Pick report → brief → pay → ops delivers file to account ≤72h → client notified → feedback request	Delivery happens inside the platform (not “check your email thread”)

9 Functional Requirements Register (MoSCoW)

IDs referenced in specs, QA and invoicing milestones

ID	Requirement	Priority	Phase
FR-01	Responsive listings catalogue with filter/sort/search from dealer-fed inventory (§6.2)	MUST	P1
FR-02	Vehicle detail pages with gallery, spec grid, trust components, enquiry & WhatsApp CTAs (§6.3)	MUST	P1
FR-03	Three-grade verification badge system + tooltips, admin-controlled (§3.5)	MUST	P1
FR-04	Homepage per §6.1 incl. car search bar, inventory grid, services suite grid	MUST	P1
FR-05	Concierge multi-step request with retainer payment + tracking-ID status page (§6.5)	MUST	P1
FR-06	Services hub + 9 service pages on shared template with inline booking/request forms (§6.7)	MUST	P1
FR-07	Inspection booking: slots, payment, assignment, mobile checklist → auto PDF report (§6.7, §7.3)	MUST	P1
FR-08	Paystack/Flutterwave checkout incl. webhooks, receipts, refund flagging (§11)	MUST	P1
FR-09	WhatsApp integration: deep links with prefilled refs, floating button, click-to-chat on leads (§11)	MUST	P1
FR-10	Admin: listings moderation, verification grades, expiry automation, sold archive (§7.3)	MUST	P1
FR-11	Admin: leads/CRM-lite inbox with assignment, statuses, WhatsApp templates (§7.3)	MUST	P1
FR-12	Admin: bookings calendar & inspector dispatch incl. mobile job view (§7.3)	MUST	P1
FR-13	Auth: phone-first customer accounts with dashboard (requests/bookings/orders/saved) (§7.1)	MUST	P1
FR-14	Sell/Swap intake flows + auto valuation request task (§6.6)	MUST	P1
FR-15	Products shop: categories, cart, guest checkout, delivery fee rules, orders module (§6.8)	MUST	P1
FR-16	Compare tool (≤3 cars, admin-defined comparison rows) (§6.4)	SHOULD	P1
FR-17	Dealer portal: dashboard, listing wizard, leads inbox, freshness nudges (§7.2)	SHOULD	P2
FR-18	Dealer commission ledger & statements; add-on service purchases (§7.2)	SHOULD	P2
FR-19	Concierge options-page auto-render (comparison PDF/page from listing data) (§7.3)	SHOULD	P2
FR-20	Tracking subscriptions module: activation checklist, renewal reminders, online renewals (§7.3)	SHOULD	P2
FR-21	Milestone/protected-payment tracker with approvals & audit log (§7.3)	SHOULD	P2

FR-22	Hire management: pool registry, calendar, booking records (\$7.3)	SHOULD	P2
FR-23	Price-intel table driving price-position indicators + valuation bands (\$7.3)	SHOULD	P2
FR-24	Blog core: CMS publishing workflow (draft/review/schedule/publish), post pages with Article schema & OG cards, categories, video posts, service-CTA footers, feedback widget (\$6.9)	MUST	P1
FR-25	Saved cars & saved searches with price-drop/new-match alerts (WhatsApp/email)	SHOULD	P2
FR-26	Dealer recruitment funnel page <code>/partner</code> with application form → admin approval (\$6.7)	MUST	P1
FR-27	Reports: sales/leads/revenue exports, KPI dashboard home (\$7.3)	SHOULD	P2
FR-28	Referral module (links, attribution, reward status) (\$7.1)	COULD	P3
FR-29	Instant valuation widget from price-intel data (\$6.6)	COULD	P3
FR-30	PWA (installable, offline shell, push via web notifications)	COULD	P3
FR-31	WhatsApp Cloud API two-way bot (lead capture inside chat, template journeys)	COULD	P3
FR-32	Multi-city inventory structure (Owerri/Aba/Benin) with area switcher	COULD	P3
FR-33	Dealer bulk CSV/API listing import	COULD	P3
FR-34	Financing-lead partner handoff module	COULD	P3
FR-35	Blog enhancements: author pages, tag taxonomy with listing auto-suggestions, RSS feed, related-posts engine, dynamic car-listing embeds, editorial calendar view (\$6.9)	SHOULD	P2

Phases defined in §18. “P1” = MVP launch scope. Any **MUST** failing at acceptance = no sign-off.

10 Data & Content Model

Core entities and the vehicle listing schema developers should implement

10.1 Core Entities (relationship overview)

- **VehicleListing** ← belongs to → **Dealer**; has many **Media**, **Lead**; optional one **InspectionReport**.
- **User** (customer) has many **ServiceRequest** (types: concierge, sell, swap, documents, research, parts, consultation), **Booking** (inspection/install/consultation), **Order** (shop/tracker), **Subscription** (tracking), **SavedCar/SavedSearch**.
- **Dealer** has many Listings, **LeadAssignment**, **CommissionEntry**, **DealerOrder**.
- **Payment** polymorphic: retainer, order, booking, subscription renewal, milestone; links to PSP reference.
- **Article**, **Page**, **FAQ**, **Testimonial** via CMS. **PriceBand** (make/model/year → min/max) powers price-position.
- **HireVehicle** (pool), **HireBooking**, **IncidentLog**.

10.2 Vehicle Listing Schema (summary — full field table in Appendix B)

Group	Fields (abridged)
Identity	id, stock_no, dealer_id, status(draft/in_review/live/reserved/sold/expired), verification_grade, created/updated/published_at, expires_at
Vehicle	make, model, year, trim, vin(hidden), body_type, transmission, fuel_type, engine_size, drivetrain, ext_colour, int_colour, condition(tokunbo/nigerian_used/new), mileage_km, features[]
Commercial	asking_price, negotiable(bool), market_band_min/max (auto from PriceBand), price_position (computed), commission_terms_ref
Location & docs	city, area, documents{customs, registration, duty_sighted}, flood_check(none/pass/suspect), accident_flag
Content	description, honest_note, media[] {url,type,video}, inspection_report_id?, seo_slug
Metrics	views, enquiries, saves (counters for dealer/admin stats)

VIN visible to ops only. All prices stored as integer kobo internally; displayed ₦ formatted.

11 Integrations & Third-Party Services

Plumbing list with purpose, phase and failure behaviour

Service	Purpose	Phase	Notes / Failure Behaviour
Paystack or Flutterwave	Card/bank/transfer payments; recurring (subscriptions); transfers API for dealer payouts; split payments later	P1	Webhooks verified; pending-transfer states supported (bank transfer is common); all amounts confirmed via webhook, never client-side
WhatsApp Business	P1: wa.me deep links w/ prefilled text incl. car stock #; click-to-chat lead source tags. P3: Cloud API bot	P1 / P3	Every chat entry tagged with source (VDP id, service page) for attribution
OTP SMS (e.g., Termii/Twilio)	Phone verification, critical alerts fallback	P1	WhatsApp-first where possible; SMS as fallback channel
Email (SendGrid/Resend etc.)	Receipts, reports delivery, notifications, deal alerts	P1	Transactional templates branded; SPF/DKIM configured
Google Maps / Places	Inspection-location capture, area autocomplete (PH areas), meet-point pins	P2	Graceful degradation to manual text input offline/low-data mode
GA4 + Meta Pixel	Analytics & ad attribution (\$15)	P1	Consent banner; server-side events for purchases where feasible
Telematics partner portal	Tracker provisioning/subscription status; deep-link from customer account	P2	Manual sync acceptable initially; API if partner offers one
reCAPTCHA / Turnstile	Spam control on all public forms	P1	Invisible mode to protect the minimalist UX
Storage + CDN (S3-compatible + CDN)	Media pipeline: on-upload compress/resize WebP variants, video transcoding later	P1	Serve scaled variants only; originals retained

12 Non-Functional Requirements

Performance budgets, security, privacy, SEO-tech, reliability

12.1 Performance Budgets (hard requirements)

Metric	Budget	Context
LCP (listings, VDP, home)	< 2.5s	Moto-G-class Android, Chrome, "Fast 3G" profile
INP / CLS	< 200ms / < 0.1	Core Web Vitals all-green on key templates
Initial page weight (compressed)	≤ 1.2MB home · ≤ 1.5MB VDP	Images WebP/AVIF, responsive srcset, lazy below fold
JS bundle	≤ 180KB gz initial	Route-level code splitting; no heavy framework bleed on public pages
Fonts	2 families max, subset, <code>font-display: swap</code>	Self-hosted
Server response (TTFB)	< 600ms cached / < 1.2s dynamic	Full-page cache for listings; CDN edge for assets

12.2 Security & Privacy

- HTTPS everywhere (HSTS); OWASP ASVS baseline: parameterised queries, XSS escaping, CSRF tokens, rate-limited auth/OTP, secure headers.
- **RBAC** per §7.4; least-privilege staff accounts; MFA for admin roles; full **audit log** of sensitive actions (grades, refunds, releases, price overrides).
- Payments: never store card data (PSP-hosted fields only); webhook signature verification; idempotent order processing.
- **NDPA compliance**: consent capture for marketing/opt-ins (deal alerts), privacy policy, data-subject request handling (export/delete), minimal PII in analytics, encrypted at rest where supported.
- Media: strip EXIF geotags from uploaded photos; dealers never see buyer phone unless lead policy allows.
- Admin access IP-allowlist **COULD**; daily automated backups + quarterly restore test; secrets in env vars/manager, never repo.

12.3 Reliability & Operability

- Uptime target 99.5%+; uptime monitor with alert to ops WhatsApp/email; status handling for PSP downtime (queue "awaiting payment" gracefully).
- Error monitoring (e.g., Sentry-class tool) on front & back; structured logs; health endpoint.
- Migrations reversible; staging environment mandatory; feature flags for portal release.

12.4 SEO-Technical Requirements

- Server-rendered or statically generated public pages (no client-only content); clean slugs (§14); canonical tags; XML sitemap auto-regenerating on listing changes; robots directives sane.
- Core Web Vitals green = ranking requirement, not vanity (§12.1).

- Schema.org JSON-LD: `Vehicle + Offer` on VDPs, `LocalBusiness` site-wide, `FAQPage` where FAQs, `Article` on blog posts, `BreadcrumbList`.
- **Open Graph/Twitter cards tuned for WhatsApp sharing** (og:image 1200×630 auto-composited with car photo + price badge would be ideal; minimum: correct image/title/description).

13 Mobile-First & Low-Bandwidth Strategy

Because that is how Port Harcourt will actually use this site

13.1 Responsive Plan

Breakpoint	Key behaviours
≤ 480px (primary)	Design starts here. 1-col cards (2-col only for shop), bottom-sheet filters, sticky bottom nav, sticky VDP CTA bar ("Request Viewing · WhatsApp"), thumb-reach primary actions, no hover dependencies
481-768px	2-col grids; filter sheet persists; header compresses to hamburger earlier
769-1200px	Left filter rail appears; 3-col cards; sticky VDP right rail
> 1200px	Max-width 1200px container; no layout surprises; enhanced hover states

13.2 Low-Bandwidth & Data-Conscious Features

- Progressive image loading (blur-up placeholders), adaptive quality on `Save-Data` header, video strictly tap-to-load with duration/size label.
- Filters update via lightweight fetch; forms resilient to connection drops (local-state drafts, "resume where you left off").
- Offline-tolerant PWA shell `COULD`: cached listings shell + queued enquiries that send when back online.
- All critical journeys (view car → enquire → concierge → pay) must complete comfortably on a #data-conscious connection — QA tests on throttled profiles (§18.3).

13.3 Mobile-Specific UX Rules

- Tap targets ≥ 44px; calls/WhatsApp links use native protocols; numbers inputmode="numeric".
- Photo galleries: swipeable, pinch zoom, fullscreen; upload flows accept camera capture directly (dealer wizard, sell/swap, documents).
- Sticky CTAs never cover content; safe-area insets respected; no interstitials or app-download nagging.

14 SEO & Growth Foundations

Own “car” searches in Port Harcourt, then widen

14.1 URL & Keyword Architecture

Page type	Pattern	Target intent examples
VDP	/cars/2015-toyota-camry-le- {stock}	“2015 camry for sale port harcourt”
Listing facets (indexable subset only)	/cars/toyota , /cars/toyota/ camry , /cars/suv-under-15m	“tokunbo camry price in PH”, “suv under 15 million naira”
Services	/services/inspection etc.	“car inspection service port harcourt”, “customs verification nigeria”
Blog	/blog/{slug}	Long-tail ownership & buying questions (content plan §16)

Facet pages hand-curated (title, intro copy, canonical rules); raw filter combinations stay `noindex` to avoid thin-page bloat. Sold archive pages 301 to relevant facet after 90 days.

14.2 On-Page Templates (meta patterns)

- **VDP title:** “{Year} {Make} {Model} {Trim} for Sale in Port Harcourt — ₦{price} | HonestCars” · description with mileage/condition/verification grade.
- **Service title:** “{Service} in Port Harcourt — {promise + from-price} | HonestCars”.
- H1 uniqueness enforced; image alt text auto-composed from vehicle fields (editable).

14.3 Local & Off-Site

- Google Business Profile (service-area business), NAP consistency, review capture flow post-delivery (§15 events), LocalBusiness schema with geo for PH.
- Directory/profile citations (Nigerian business directories), dealer cross-linking where agreed, content-led organic + YouTube interlinking with the Blog.

15 Analytics & Event Tracking

If it makes money or leaks money, it gets an event

15.1 Event Plan (implement via GA4 + server-side where feasible)

Category	Events (snake_case)
Discovery	search_used (query, filters), filter_applied, sort_changed, saved_search_created
Listing	listing_impression, listing_view (id, grade, price_position), gallery_engaged, compare_added, whatsapp_click (source), viewing_requested
Funnels	concierge_started/step_completed/abandoned/retainer_paid · booking_started/completed (type) · sell_swap_submitted · hire_requested · consultation_purchased
Commerce	view_item/add_to_cart/begin_checkout/purchase (enhanced ecommerce), subscription_renewed
Dealer/ B2B	dealer_application_submitted, dealer_login_active (weekly cohort), services_enquiry_submitted
Brand	article_read_75, blog_post_shared, deal_alert_signup, review_link_clicked

15.2 Dashboards & Reporting

- **Marketing dashboard:** channel → lead → paid conversion by funnel; CAC guardrails.
- **Ops dashboard** (admin home §7.3): funnel counts, SLA timers, revenue by pillar.
- UTM discipline document issued; paid campaigns must not launch before events verified in QA (§18.3).

16 Content Requirements & Copy Direction

What the client must supply / what the writer produces, before build freeze

16.1 Content Inventory (owner → due)

Asset	Qty (launch)	Owner
Homepage hero + section copy (per §6.1)	1 set	Writer with client voice review
Service pages (template §6.7)	9 pages complete (copy, FAQs, price cards)	Writer + client ops review
Seed listings with full photo sets (12+ shots)	≥ 60 listings across 10+ partners	Client network + media unit
Blog posts (incl. Honest Buyer's Guide series)	8 posts + 3 embedded videos	Client content lead
Testimonials with photos/areas	6–8	Client (from pilot inspections/concierge)
Verification explainer + case photos	1 page + 6 “catch” examples	Client inspection team
Legal pages (terms, privacy-NDPA, refunds, disclaimer)	4 docs	Client legal retainer → CMS
Dealer photo-style guide (1-pager PDF)	1	Designer + client
Microcopy library (buttons, errors, empties, notifications, WhatsApp templates)	Full set	Writer (uses Appendix D baseline)

16.2 Voice Rules Recap (bind to §3.6)

- Numbers over adjectives; promise + proof adjacent; every price says what it includes.
- No FOMO spam, no fake countdowns, no “hot deal!!!” — the honesty IS the pitch.
- Nigerian-context fluency without stereotype: “Tokunbo”, “PH traffic”, “customs papers” used naturally and explained once.

17 Technical Approach & Stack Options

Recommendation + decision criteria — final choice minuted in kickoff (§19)

Option	Sketch	Pros	Cons	Best if...
A — Custom (recommended)	Next.js/Nuxt + Postgres (e.g., Supabase) + headless admin; PWA-ready	Exact fit for portals/ checklist tools; best performance control; scales to P2/P3 features; own data model	Higher upfront cost; needs competent team + maintenance plan	Budget allows; portals & ops tooling are strategic assets (they are — §7)
B — WordPress + plugins	Listings plugin (JetEngine/ Crocoblock + WooCommerce + custom admin flows	Fastest/cheapest MVP; huge talent pool; CMS strength	Dealer portal/dispatch/ milestone tooling becomes plugin-frankenstein; performance discipline harder; security hygiene burden	Speed-to-market & budget dominate; accept rebuild at scale
C — Hybrid	Custom storefront & portals + WordPress only as content CMS (or headless WP)	Balanced; strong content ops; custom where it matters	Two systems to run; integration seams	Content volume is high early and team is mixed-skill

RECOMMENDATION

Option A — the dealer portal, inspection dispatch and milestone tooling are core business differentiators, not website garnish; they deserve a real application. If budget forces Option B, scope P1 to storefront + bookings + lead CRM only, with a written migration path and data export guarantee (no lock-in).

Regardless-of-stack Requirements

- Git + code review + staging/production environments; CI lint/test; secrets management; daily backups; documented handover (repo, hosting, DNS, env README).
- Full code & data ownership by HonestCars LTD (contract clause); admin documentation + 2 recorded training sessions + 30-day post-launch support window.

18 Build Phasing, Deliverables & Acceptance

Suggested 14-week plan to full Phase-2; adjust with team capacity

Phase / Weeks	Scope	Exit Gate
P0 — Discovery & Design Weeks 1-3	Kickoff & stack decision; design system in Figma (mobile-first templates: home, listings, VDP, concierge, service, admin key screens); content production starts (\$16); infra/DNS/PSP accounts set up	Approved designs + signed scope + content ≥ 50% loaded
P1 — MVP Build Weeks 4-9	All MUST FRs (\$9): storefront, VDP, concierge, services, inspection dispatch, shop, payments, WhatsApp, accounts, core admin (moderation/leads/orders), blog module, SEO-tech, analytics	\$18.3 acceptance passed on staging; 60+ seed listings live; soft-launch
P1.5 — Soft Launch Hardening Weeks 10-11	Real-traffic burn-in with pilot dealers; bug fixes; performance tuning to budgets; staff training; SOP alignment with ops team	Zero critical defects 5 days; team operating daily via admin
P2 — Portals & Recurring Weeks 12-14+	SHOULD set: dealer portal, subscriptions, milestones, hire mgmt, price-intel, blog enhancements, reports, alerts	Dealer self-serve ≥ 60% of new listings; renewals & statements digital
P3 — Growth features Backlog	COULD items (\$9) by business priority	Quarterly roadmap review

18.2 Deliverables Checklist (agency/team → client)

- ☐ Figma design system + all approved screens (mobile & desktop)
- ☐ Production website, dealer portal, admin console on client-owned hosting & domain
- ☐ Source repository with README (build, deploy, env), database schema doc
- ☐ Payment/webhook configuration evidence + test transaction log
- ☐ Analytics property with implemented event plan (\$15) + dashboards
- ☐ SEO pack: sitemap, schema validation report, OG preview tests (incl. WhatsApp)
- ☐ Blog live with launch content loaded (min. 8 posts incl. the Honest Buyer's Guide series)
- ☐ Performance audit report proving \$12.1 budgets on key templates
- ☐ Training: 2 live sessions + recorded walkthroughs + quick-start PDF for staff & dealers
- ☐ 30-day warranty bug-fix window + handover/on-call contacts sheet

18.3 Acceptance Criteria (samples — QA builds full suite from §8 + §9)

- ☐ 2-tap test passes from homepage to: a car, concierge form, inspection booking, shop, WhatsApp (mobile)
- ☐ J1-J7 journeys complete end-to-end on staging with real PSP test cards and real WhatsApp numbers
- ☐ Dealer submits listing from a mid-range Android over 3G in < 10 minutes incl. photos
- ☐ Inspection checklist → client PDF renders correctly with photos and grades; delivered ≤ 4h SLA path works
- ☐ Core Web Vitals green on home/listings/VDP on throttled profile; page weights within budget

- ☐ Payment flows: success, failed, abandoned, webhook-retry, refund flag — all states recorded correctly
- ☐ Dealer contact info does not appear anywhere public (code & content audit)
- ☐ Admin RBAC enforced (test each §7.4 cell); audit log captures sensitive actions
- ☐ Sold & expired listings follow §6.2 behaviour; SEO facet rules respected
- ☐ NDPA consent records exist for deal-alert signups; privacy requests actionable in admin

19 Open Questions & Decisions for the Client

Resolve at kickoff — blockers marked ●

#	Decision Needed	Options / Recommendation
●	Stack choice (§17)	Option A recommended; confirm budget envelope & team
●	Hosting & domain	Confirm honestcarsltd.com DNS control; recommended managed VPS/PaaS with Nigeria-friendly latency + CDN
●	Payment merchant	Paystack vs Flutterwave business account, KYC completed, settlement bank linked
●	Launch pricing on site	Final ₦ figures for retainers, inspections, consultations, trackers, delivery fees (from Operating Doc §12)
	Brand assets	Final logo files, or commission simple wordmark refresh within \$3 system
	WhatsApp Business	Dedicated business number decision; listed phone vs chat-only policy
	Lead phone-masking policy	Show full buyer phone to dealers vs masked-till-viewing (recommend masked-till-appointed)
	Finance partner	Any bank/MFB partner for “financing needed?” concierge branch, or defer (FR-34)
	Content cadence owners	Who publishes weekly blog content & who maintains price-intel table (ops roles)
	Dealer pilot list	First 10 dealers for soft launch listing seeding & portal pilot

20 Appendices

Wireframes • data schema • navigation map • microcopy • pre-flight checklist

Appendix A — Reference Wireframes (guides, not pixel law)

A-1. Homepage (desktop)

DESKTOP • 1200PX CONTAINER

LOGO • BUY CARS • SERVICES ▼ • SELL/SWAP • HIRE • GUIDE • [SEARCH] • [ACCOUNT] • [FIND MY CAR]

H1 — “EVERY VEHICLE VERIFIED. EVERY PRICE COMPARED. EVERY DEAL HONEST.”

[MAKE ▼] [MODEL ▼] [MAX BUDGET ₦] [SEARCH]
TRUST CHIPS: 412 CARS LIVE • 37 PARTNER DEALERS • PH

HERO IMAGE / CERTIFIED CAR OF THE WEEK

FRESH ON THE MARKET — 8 CAR CARDS (TABS: ALL / CERTIFIED / UNDER ₦10M / SUVs) • VIEW ALL →

HOW IT WORKS ①

②

③

VERIFICATION GRADES STRIP ● NETWORK-LISTED • ● FIELD-CHECKED • ● CERTIFIED

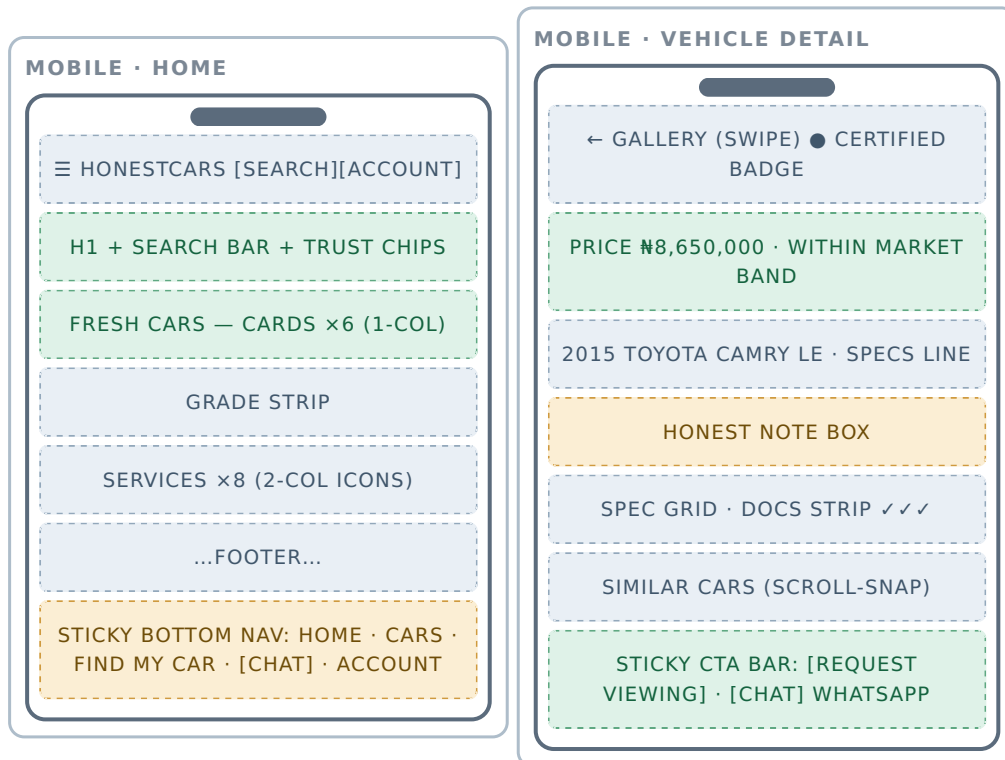
SERVICE CARDS ×8 (INSPECTION • CONCIERGE • DOCUMENTS • SELL/SWAP • TRACKING • HIRE • RESEARCH • PARTS)

TESTIMONIALS + COUNTERS

FROM THE BLOG (3) • DEALER CTA BAND • DEAL-ALERT OPT-IN

FOOTER — SHOP / SERVICES / COMPANY / LEGAL + CONTACT + PAYMENT MARKS

A-2. Mobile — Homepage & VDP



Appendix B — Vehicle Listing Field Schema (full)

Field	Type	Req?	Notes
stock_no	string, unique	✓	Auto: HC-PH-0001
dealer_id	FK dealer	✓	Source listing owner
status	enum	✓	draft/in_review/live/reserved/sold/expired
verification_grade	enum	✓	network_listed/field_checked/certified; default network_listed
make / model / year / trim	taxonomy+str	✓	Controlled lists; feeds facets/SEO
vin	string	—	Ops-only visibility; encrypted at rest
body_type / transmission / fuel_type / drivetrain	enums	✓/✓/✓/—	Filter facets
engine_size, ext_colour, int_colour	str	—	
condition	enum	✓	tokunbo / nigerian_used / new
mileage_km	int	✓	Odometer; + mileage_verified bool (inspector)
asking_price	int (kobo)	✓	+ negotiable bool
price_band_min/max	int	auto	From PriceBand table; powers price_position enum(below/within/premium/no_data)
city / area	enum/str	✓	Default Port Harcourt; area list admin-managed

documents{ }	json	✓	customs_verified, registration, duty_sighted, tinted_permit
flood_check / accident_flag	enums	—	none/pass/suspect ; none/yes/repaired
features[]	json array	—	Chips on VDP
description / honest_note	text	✓/—	honest_note required when certified
media[]	rel	≥ 8 photos	type: image/video/360; order; alt auto
inspection_report_id	FK	—	Attaches grade, codes, photos, verdict
views / enquiries / saves	ints	auto	Dealer + admin stats
seo_slug	string	auto	{year}-{make}-{model}-{trim}-{stock}
created/published/updated/ expires_at	datetime	auto	14-day expiry default w/ refresh flow

Appendix C — Navigation & Footer Map (final labels)

Header

Buy Cars (→/cars) · Services ▼ [Inspection · Find My Car · Customs & Documents · Sell/Swap · Tracking · Car Hire · Research & Reports · Consultation · Spare Parts] · Sell/Swap (/sell-swap) · Hire (/hire) · Blog · Find My Car [button] · Search · Account

Footer columns

① Shop: All Cars, Certified Cars, Compare, Find My Car, Sell/Swap, Hire ② Services: all 8 + Shop ③ Company: About, Verification, Partner With Us, Blog, FAQ, Contact ④ Legal: Terms, Privacy, Refunds, Disclaimer + contact block + CAC line

Appendix D — Microcopy Library (starting set)

Context	Copy
Hero H1/sub	“Every vehicle verified. Every price compared. Every deal honest.” / “Verified cars from 37+ trusted Port Harcourt lots — with inspections, documents and negotiation handled for you.”
Empty results	“No exact matches in the network right now — but {n} cars are close. Or tell us what you want and we’ll find and verify it within 72 hours.” [Find It For Me]
VDP safety note	“All payments for this car go through HonestCars-protected channels. Never pay a seller or third party directly.”
Price-position “within”	“Priced within the current PH market band for this model and condition.”
Concierge success	“Brief received and retainer confirmed. Your search ID is HC-2481 . We’ll present up to 3 verified, inspected options within 48–72 hours — watch this page or your WhatsApp.”
Booking confirmation	“Inspection booked: {date}, {slot}, {location}. Our inspector will call 30 minutes before arrival. Report lands here within 4 hours of the check.”
Stale dealer nudge	“5 of your listings expire in 2 days. Tap to confirm they’re still available, or they’ll pause automatically.”

Error (payment) “Payment didn’t complete — no money has moved (or any debit reverses automatically). Try again, or chat with us and we’ll sort it.”

Document Control & Sign-Off

Version	Date	Author	Product Owner Sign-Off	Next Review
1.0	September 2026	Honest Cars LTD — Strategy documentation		At Phase-0 gate (design freeze)

Scope of this document: design & functional specification for honestcarsltd.com. It references, and should be read alongside, the Honest Cars LTD Business Operating Document v1.0 for service definitions, pricing philosophy and operational SOPs. Nothing herein is a commitment of final visual design, vendor selection, or legal text (legal pages to be supplied by the client’s counsel). © 2026 Honest Cars LTD — Confidential.